

Slides 3.6: Peer Influence, Pressure, and Refusal Skills

Slide outline for Lesson 3.6, two days. Slides 1 to 11 are Day 1. Slides 12 to 22 are Day 2. The scenarios use everyday pressure only; substances and sexual pressure are health class. No skit may target a real person.

Slide 1: Peer Influence, Pressure, and Refusal Skills

- Lesson 3.6, Day 1: Self-Concept, Peers, and Stress
- Unit 3: Growing Up, Getting Along
- Do now, no names: one time a friend talked someone into something good. One time a friend talked someone into something not good. A made-up person is fine Notes: Hands for “I could think of a good one.” Usually fewer than half.

Slide 2: Not always the villain

- Sometimes peer pressure is the only reason someone tries out for the team
- Today: tell the two kinds apart
- Tomorrow: exactly what to say to the bad kind Image: two arrows from a group of figures to one figure, one arrow pointing up and one pointing down.

Slide 3: Peer, peer pressure

- Peer: someone about your age or in your position
- Peer pressure: when peers push you to do, say, or think something
- It works because belonging matters, and at this age it matters a lot (Lesson 3.3) Notes: Students copy onto Part 1.

Slide 4: Positive and negative

- Positive: pushes you toward something good for you (try out, study, apologize, show up)
- Negative: pushes you toward something harmful, unfair, or against what matters to you
- Same friend can do both on the same day Notes: One example of each on Part 1.

Slide 5: Direct and indirect

- Direct: someone says it. “Come on, just do it.” “Everyone is going”
- Indirect: nobody says it. You see everyone doing it and feel it
- Indirect is quieter and often stronger Image: two panels: one figure speaking to another; a group all wearing the same thing while one figure looks down at their own shirt.

Slide 6: What giving in to the negative kind can cost

- Trouble at school or home
- A hurt friend or classmate

- Lost trust
- Something you cannot take back
- A dent in your self-concept (Lesson 3.5) Notes: Three consequences on Part 1.

Slide 7: Three pushes on one decision

- The decision: a group chat wants a student to share a photo of a classmate who did not want it shared. “Everyone has seen it anyway”
- Use the five steps: name the choice, list options, weigh each option against what matters, decide, look back
- At “weigh,” three columns: what family would say, what peers are saying, what media (the feed, the trend) says
- Which push is loudest? Which one do you want to win? Image: the five-step decision model poster from Unit 0. Notes: Part 2 grid. Land it: “what matters” is yours, not the group’s.

Slide 8: The scenario cards

- Ten cards per team
- For each card: positive or negative? Direct or indirect? Two possible outcomes (things that could happen next)
- Specific outcomes. “Bad things” is not an outcome
- Star your two hardest. 13 minutes Notes: Grade 6 and IEP/504: six cards. Circulate with the clipboard.

Slide 9: Share

- One team: your hardest card and two outcomes
- Room: what would you say?
- I write the answers on the board. Tomorrow they become four steps Notes: Take three lines. Leave them on the board overnight if you can.

Slide 10: Day 1 exit card

- 3 kinds of peer pressure with one example each
- 2 consequences of giving in to the negative kind
- 1 push (family, peers, media) that is loudest for most people your age, and why Notes: Two students read their “1.”

Slide 11: Tomorrow

- Four refusal steps
- Your team plans and performs a 60 to 90 second skit
- Keep your starred cards Notes: Skit teams are the same teams. Say it now.

Slide 12: Day 2: What exactly do you say?

- Do now: finish this sentence three different ways: “No thanks, I ___”

- Then the four steps, a model, and your skit Notes: Three sentences. Some will be the whole skit.

Slide 13: The four refusal steps

1. Say no clearly (a hand up). Short. No apology
 2. Give a reason (a speech bubble). Yours. Simple: “not my thing”
 3. Offer an alternative (an arrow). “Let’s go to the courts instead”
 4. Walk away (a door). You can just leave. That counts as a no
- You do not need all four. They do not have to be in order. Two is often enough Notes: Students copy onto Part 4.

Slide 14: Why “no apology”

- “Sorry, sorry, I really wish I could, but...” invites a second push
- “No thanks” is complete
- A reason that starts an argument is not a reason. “I have a game tomorrow” is hard to argue with Notes: This is the most common skit mistake. Say it before the skits.

Slide 15: The model

- Card: one of yesterday’s hardest
- Pusher script: “Come on. Everyone is doing it. Do not be boring.”
- Refuser: step 1, then step 3, then step 4 if it continues
- Watch which step comes first Notes: A volunteer plays the pusher from the script. You refuse. Then ask: which step did I use first?

Slide 16: Skit planner

- One of your two starred cards
- Roles: pusher, refuser, a second friend (optional), narrator or director
- Which steps, in what order, one line each
- What the pusher does after
- 60 to 90 seconds. No real names. No real people. No drugs, alcohol, or vaping. Nothing physical
- Get my initials before you perform. 10 minutes Notes: Initial every plan. Ten seconds per team.

Slide 17: Performances

- Two minutes per team, including reset
- Audience: feedback slip for each skit. Which steps did you see? Strongest line? One suggestion?
- No applause until the end. Then applause for everyone Notes: Keep the order moving. 14 minutes.

Slide 18: Feedback slip

- Steps I saw: said no clearly / gave a reason / offered an alternative / walked away

- Strongest line
- One suggestion
- Rating: worked / mostly worked / hard to tell. Because Notes: Three slips per student. Assign which skits each student rates so every team gets slips.

Slide 19: Debrief

- Which step showed up in the most skits?
- Which one was hardest to say out loud?
- The hardest one to say in a skit is the hardest one to say in the hallway. That is the one to practice Notes: Read one slip from another team aloud (the strongest line, not the suggestion).

Slide 20: Positive pressure

- The same steps work in reverse: you can be the friend who says “come try out with me”
- Grade 8 stretch: a one-page peer advice guide, “What to say when”
- Include the four steps, three of today’s best lines, and one line on being the friend who pushes up Notes: The best guides go on the wall.

Slide 21: Day 2 exit line

- “The refusal step I will practice this week is ___ because it was hardest to say”
- Not read aloud Notes: On the bottom of the planner.

Slide 22: Tomorrow

- Stress: what it is, and where yours lives
- A private map. Nobody reads it Notes: Collect the feedback slips by team before students leave.